

A STEWARD'S FIRST WALK

Attention before the context window. Forty-five minutes, one place, four registers of being, six guides holding six keys.

DRAFT. SARAH'S WORDS GO OVER THE TOP OF MINE.

THE SPINE

EIGHT MOVEMENTS, ABOUT 45 MINUTES

- One rule holds the whole thing together: no screens until movement six.



00

2 MIN

The threshold

Phones into the bag. Watch or paper timer only. Name out loud what each of you is carrying into this, including the thing you would rather not be carrying.

SPOKEN

We are going to pay attention to this place before we ask a machine anything about it.



01

6 MIN

Listen to now

Standing or sitting, not walking. No talking, no notes. Count sounds on your fingers if you need somewhere to put the attention. Copenhagen offers water, bells, bikes, gulls, wind, ventilation. Hold until the timer, past the point where it gets uncomfortable.

SPOKEN

Listen to now. Six minutes. Nothing to produce at the end of it.



02

6 MIN

How do we feel this place

Now speak. Each of you names the sense that dominated, the sense that was missing or suppressed, and one thing your body did without being asked. Write only after saying it.

SPOKEN

What senses stand out? And which one did this place shut down?



03

2 MIN

The fork

Lay the four register cards down. This is the only moment of the walk that is a choice rather than an instruction. Each of you takes one, and says why, in one sentence.

SPOKEN

We want to map a complicated terrain with our hearts, our bodies, our minds and our agents. What do you want to speak from first?



04

10 MIN

Walk the register

Follow the three beats on the card you took, out loud, while walking. When you finish your own, pick up the register the other person did not choose and walk that one too. The trap line on each card is the thing to watch for in yourself, not in each other.



05

8 MIN

Conjure a guide

Six guides, face down. Draw one, or choose one if the terrain has already told you who it wants. Take the key and perform the act on the card, here, before any of it becomes language for a machine.

SPOKEN

Each guide holds a key. The key does not explain the place. It opens a part of it you were not looking at.



06

8 MIN

The context window

Phones out. The guide comes into the window with you, and the key is the constraint: the guide asks, it does not answer. Give the agent what you noticed first, then the key, then ask it what you missed. Notice the moment your attention leaves the place and goes into the screen. That moment is the subject.

SPOKEN

You are not the guide. You hold the guide's key. Here is what we noticed. Ask us what we did not.



07

3 MIN

The return

Screens away again. Two questions, then the capture sheet: what did the agent reach that you could not, and what did you hold that it could not get near. The sheet becomes the first field note.



REGISTER

HEART

What here would you defend, and from what?

- 1 The attachment.
- 2 The loss you can already name.
- 3 Who else holds it.

Trap: feeling standing in for a claim.



REGISTER

BODY

What is your body registering that has not yet become words?

- 1 The sense that dominated.
- 2 The sense that was shut down.
- 3 What you moved away from.

Trap: describing the view instead of the sensation.



REGISTER

MIND

What structure do you think is operating here?

- 1 The pattern.
- 2 The counter-example.
- 3 Who the pattern pays.

Trap: arriving with the answer already loaded.



REGISTER

AGENT

What would you set a machine looking for, and what will it miss?

- 1 The question worth delegating.
- 2 The context it cannot have.
- 3 What you will check by hand afterwards.

Trap: opening the window before the other three have spoken.

GUIDE



URSULA LE GUIN

KEY: THE BAG

TERRAIN

What this place holds, rather than what it does.

THE ACT

Name five things this place carries. Then one it refuses to carry.

BRING BACK

A list, not a story.

IN THE WINDOW

Ask for the container, not the conflict.

GUIDE



CARLO ROVELLI

KEY: THE INTERVAL

TERRAIN

The durations layered in one site. Tidal, seasonal, budgetary, electoral, a training run.

THE ACT

Name three clocks running here at different speeds. Say which one the place is governed by.

BRING BACK

Three speeds and their units.

IN THE WINDOW

Ask what changes if the question is asked in a different clock.

GUIDE



WALTER BENJAMIN

KEY: THE FRAGMENT

TERRAIN

The outmoded and the discarded. The past lodged inside the present.

THE ACT

Pick up one thrown-away thing. Read it as a document.

BRING BACK

The object itself, in your pocket.

IN THE WINDOW

Give the agent the fragment before you give it the frame.

GUIDE



DAVID GRAEBER

KEY: THE IOU

TERRAIN

Obligation. The arbitrary wearing the clothes of the necessary.

THE ACT

Name one rule everybody here obeys that somebody made up.

BRING BACK

The rule, and who it pays.

IN THE WINDOW

Ask how else it could have been made, and who would have had to agree.

GUIDE



ELINOR OSTROM

KEY: THE BOUNDARY

TERRAIN

Rules in use, as distinct from rules on paper.

THE ACT

Draw the edge of one shared thing here. Then find out who watches it.

BRING BACK

A boundary and a monitor.

IN THE WINDOW

Hold what you drew against her eight design principles and see which are missing.

THE NAME

She and Vincent Ostrom called their Bloomington centre a Workshop, not an institute: artisans, tools, apprentices, things made and repaired in company. It is the closest existing description of what we are doing.

GUIDE



JAMES LOVELOCK

KEY: THE INSTRUMENT

TERRAIN

Metabolism. Heat, water, air, load. The heat you are standing in has a source, and in Denmark some of it comes back as district heating.

THE ACT

If you could read only this place's breath, how would you know it is alive?

BRING BACK

One flow you could actually measure.

IN THE WINDOW

Ask what a probe passing overhead would read in the atmosphere here.

A pairing, if the terrain turns to governance. Draw Graeber and Ostrom together. One key opens what is arbitrary and could be otherwise, the other opens what has endured because somebody maintains it. The argument between them is the useful part.

CAPTURE SHEET

MOVEMENT 07. BECOMES THE FIRST FIELD NOTE

One sheet each. Written by hand, typed up later only if it earns it.

PLACE, DATE, WEATHER, HOUR

SENSE THAT DOMINATED / SENSE THAT WAS SHUT DOWN

GUIDE, KEY, AND WHAT IT OPENED

WHAT IT COULD NOT GET NEAR

WHAT I HEARD IN THE SIX MINUTES

REGISTER I SPOKE FROM FIRST, AND WHY

WHAT THE AGENT REACHED THAT I COULD NOT

ONE LINE I WOULD KEEP

WHAT TO BRING

TONIGHT

- ☐ These pages printed. The guide cards cut apart so they can be drawn face down.
- ☐ A bag the phones go into, and stay in.
- ☐ A timer that is not a phone.
- ☐ Pen and paper for both of you.
- ☐ Two places: somewhere to sit still for movement 01, somewhere to walk for movement 04.
- ☐ One place you have both never paid attention to, which is where movement 05 works best.